PEW RESEARCH CENTER
July 28-31, 2011 OMNIBUS
FINAL TOPLINE
N=1001

ASK ALL:

PEW.1 As I read a list of some stories covered by news organizations this past week, please tell me if you happened to follow each news story very closely, fairly closely, not too closely, or not at all closely. First, **[INSERT ITEM; RANDOMIZE;] [IF NECESSARY** "Did you follow **[ITEM]** very closely, fairly closely, not too closely or not at all closely?"**]**

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
a. A bombing and shooting attack in Norway that killed more than 70 people					
July 28-31, 2011	24	33	20	23	*
July 23-24, 2011: *A bombing and shooting attack in Norway that killed over 90 people*	26	31	17	26	1
TREND FOR COMPARISON:					
January 27-30, 2011: *Suicide bombings at an airport in Russia that killed at least 35 people*	14	30	24	31	1
April 1-5, 2010: *Suicide bombings in Russia*	10	26	24	40	*
July 17-20, 2009: *The bombing of two hotels in Indonesia*	13	26	23	36	2
December 5-8, 2008: *The terrorist attacks in Mumbai, India*	29	37	20	14	*
September 26-29, 2008: *A bombing at a Marriott Hotel in Pakistan that killed over 50 people*	16	32	23	28	1
July 6-9, 2007: *Investigation into who was responsible for car bombs that were discovered in London and a car bomb that went off at an airport in Scotland*	34	30	19	16	1
June 29-July 2, 2007: *London car bomb*	34	31	16	18	1
October, 2005: *The recent terrorist bombings in Bali, Indonesia*	13	31	26	29	1
July, 2005: *The terrorist bombings in London, England*	48	37	11	4	*
September, 2004: *The killing of Russian school children by Chechen rebels*	48	30	11	10	1
March, 2004: *The terrorist bombings in Madrid, Spain*	34	35	18	12	1
Late October, 2002: *The terrorist bombing of a nightclub in Bali, Indonesia*	20	34	25	20	1
b. Reports about the condition of the U.S. economy					
July 28-31, 2011	43	30	13	13	*
July 21-24, 2011	41	32	13	13	1
July 14-17, 2011	41	30	14	14	1
July 7-10, 2011	36	30	15	18	1
June 30-July 3, 2011	38	32	13	16	1
June 23-26, 2011	37	29	15	19	*
June 16-19, 2011	39	33	14	13	*
June 9-12, 2011	39	30	15	16	1
June 2-5, 2011	35	34	17	14	*
May 19-22, 2011	33	34	17	16	*
May 12-15, 2011	32	32	17	18	2
May 5-8, 2011	40	35	15	9	1
April 21-25, 2011	41	33	12	14	*

PEW.1 CONTINUED...

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
April 14-17, 2011	44	30	14	12	1
April 7-10, 2011	46	30	14	10	*
March 31-April 3, 2011	42	31	16	11	0
March 24-27, 2011	36	32	17	15	*
March 17-20, 2011	38	32	17	13	*
March 10-13, 2011	40	30	16	13	*
March 3-6, 2011	37	31	17	13	1
February 24-27, 2011	49	29	11	10	*
February 17-20, 2011	35	33	14	17	*
February 10-13, 2011	36	34	13	16	*
February 3-6, 2011	35	37	14	14	*
January 20-23, 2011	37	33	14	15	1
January 13-16, 2011	37	29	15	18	1
January 6-9, 2011	39	37	11	12	1
December 16-19, 2010	39	31	14	15	2
December 9-12, 2010	39	30	14	16	1
December 2-5, 2010	52	28	11	9	*
November 18-21, 2010	46	31	11	11	*
November 11-14, 2010	38	30	15	16	1
November 4-7, 2010	44	32	11	13	*
October 28-November 1, 2010	39	34	11	15	1
October 21-24, 2010	41	29	14	14	1
October 14-17, 2010	42	33	12	13	*
October 7-10, 2010	36	33	15	15	1
September 30-October 3, 2010	43	35	10	11	1
September 23-26, 2010	43	34	13	9	1
September 16-19, 2010	37	30	16	16	1
September 2-6, 2010	43	31	13	12	*
August 19-22, 2010	39	31	14	15	1
August 5-8, 2010	39	33	14	13	1
July 29-August 1, 2010	51	33	11	5	*
July 22-25, 2010	46	33	14	6	1
July 15-18, 2010	37	33	14	15	1
July 8-11, 2010	36	33	15	16	*
July 1-5, 2010	48	30	13	8	*
June 24-27, 2010	37	37	15	11	1
June 17-20, 2010	38	34	15	13	*
June 10-13, 2010	39	35	17	9	*
June 3-6, 2010	35	33	16	14	1
May 27-30, 2010	43	29	13	15	*
May 20-23, 2010	40	35	13	11	*
May 13-16, 2010	49	32	11	8	1
May 7-10, 2010	42	34	11	12	*
April 30-May 3, 2010	32	37	17	14	1
April 23-26, 2010	42	31	13	14	*
April 16-19, 2010	40	32	14	14	0
April 9-12, 2010	40	32	15	13	*
April 1-5, 2010	33	34	14	19	*
March 19-22, 2010	41	32	14	13	*
March 12-15, 2010	41	35	12	12	*
March 5-8, 2010	40	34	12	13	*
February 26-March 1, 2010	31	33	17	19	*
February 19-22, 2010	38	34	15	12	*
February 12-15, 2010	35	34	15	16	*
February 5-8, 2010	43	36	13	9	*
January 29-February 1, 2010	45	32	13	10	*
January 22-25, 2010	41	34	14	10	*
January 15-18, 2010	37	38	14	11	*
January 8-11, 2010	39	33	15	12	*

PEW.1 CONTINUED...

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
December 18-21, 2009	45	31	14	10	0
December 11-14, 2009	42	31	14	13	*
December 4-7, 2009	41	36	13	9	1
November 13-16, 2009	38	33	14	15	*
October 30-November 2, 2009	34	32	17	16	*
October 23-26, 2009	44	30	15	10	1
October 9-12, 2009	41	29	16	13	*
October 2-5, 2009	44	30	15	11	0
September 25-28, 2009	44	37	10	10	*
September 18-21, 2009	44	34	15	7	*
September 11-14, 2009	45	32	14	9	*
September 3-6, 2009	41	31	15	13	*
August 28-31, 2009	45	30	13	12	1
August 21-24, 2009	50	27	13	10	1
August 14-17, 2009	41	37	11	12	*
August 7-10, 2009	42	34	13	10	*
July 31-August 3, 2009	46	34	11	8	*
July 24-27, 2009	45	35	12	8	*
July 17-20, 2009	43	35	11	11	1
July 10-13, 2009	37	38	13	11	*
July 2-5, 2009	38	35	15	12	*
June 19-22, 2009	42	33	15	10	*
June 12-15, 2009	41	35	12	12	*
June 5-8, 2009	41	34	11	14	*
May 29-June 1, 2009	43	37	11	8	*
May 21-24, 2009	44	35	13	9	*
May 15-18, 2009	44	35	12	8	*
May 8-11, 2009	42	34	12	12	*
May 1-4, 2009	47	36	11	5	1
April 17-20, 2009	52	30	10	7	1
April 9-13, 2009	48	29	13	10	0
March 27-30, 2009	48	32	10	10	*
March 20-23, 2009	52	34	8	6	*
March 13-16, 2009	48	33	9	10	*
February 27-March 2, 2009	56	30	8	6	*
February 13-16, 2009	55	29	10	6	*
January 30-February 2, 2009	52	31	12	5	*
January 23-26, 2009	57	30	8	5	0
January 16-19, 2009	43	35	13	9	*
January 2-4, 2009	42	36	15	7	*
December 12-15, 2008	51	33	9	7	*
December 5-8, 2008	42	38	13	7	*
November 21-24, 2008	59	24	9	8	*
November 14-17, 2008	56	29	9	6	*
November 7-10, 2008	54	31	8	7	*
October 31-November 3, 2008	63	27	6	4	*
October 24-27, 2008	52	35	7	5	1
October 17-20, 2008	62	29	6	3	*
October 10-13, 2008	65	25	7	3	*
October 3-6, 2008	69	23	5	3	*
September 26-29, 2008	70	22	5	3	*
September 19-22, 2008	56	27	12	5	*
September 5-8, 2008	44	33	16	7	*
August 29-31, 2008	41	34	13	11	1
August 15-18, 2008	39	36	15	10	*
August 8-11, 2008	39	35	16	10	*
August 1-4, 2008	47	34	11	8	0
July 25-28, 2008	46	32	10	12	*
July 18-21, 2008	45	33	13	9	*

PEW.1 CONTINUED...

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	(VOL.) DK/Ref
July 11-14, 2008	44	33	12	10	1
June 27-30, 2008	49	31	12	7	1
June 13-16, 2008	42	33	14	11	*
May 9-12, 2008	45	31	13	11	*
May 2-5, 2008	43	31	15	10	1
April 18-21, 2008	41	35	13	10	1
April 4-7, 2008	39	37	12	12	*
March 28-31, 2008	42	36	14	8	*
March 20-24, 2008	45	33	13	9	*
February 29-March 3, 2008	38	35	15	11	1
February 15-18, 2008	37	36	11	16	8
February 1-4, 2008	40	37	14	8	1
January 18-21, 2008	42	31	16	11	*
January 11-14, 2008	36	32	15	16	1
November 2-5, 2007	27	37	16	19	1
October 19-22, 2007	25	34	20	21	*
August 10-13, 2007	28	36	18	18	*
Mid-November, 2006	31	40	17	11	1
December, 2005	35	35	18	11	1
Early November, 2005	35	39	17	9	*
Mid-May, 2005	30	39	19	11	1
January, 2005	35	41	17	7	*
Mid-October, 2004	30	43	16	10	1
Early September, 2004	39	34	15	11	1
Mid-January, 2004	37	41	15	7	*
December, 2003	35	38	14	11	2
November, 2003	40	34	15	10	1
October, 2003	32	39	16	12	1
September, 2003	39	30	18	12	1
March, 2003	40	35	16	8	1
February, 2003	42	33	15	10	*
December, 2002	38	34	17	10	1
February, 2002	35	40	15	9	1
January, 2002	30	44	16	9	1
December, 2001	37	40	13	8	2
Mid-November, 2001	41	36	15	7	1
June, 2001	24	41	18	16	1
May, 2001	34	36	15	15	0
April, 2001	36	34	16	13	1
February, 2001	30	39	18	12	1
January, 2001	32	38	17	11	2
June, 1995	26	41	22	11	*
March, 1995	27	45	19	9	*
February, 1995	23	41	22	13	1
December, 1994	28	43	20	9	*
October, 1994	27	40	20	12	1
June, 1994	25	42	23	10	*
May, 1994	33	40	16	10	1
January, 1994	34	39	16	10	1
Early January, 1994	36	44	13	7	*
December, 1993	35	41	15	8	1
October, 1993	33	38	20	9	*
September, 1993	37	40	14	8	1
Early September, 1993	39	39	14	9	*
August, 1993	41	36	14	9	*
May, 1993	37	38	18	6	1
February, 1993	49	36	10	5	*
January, 1993	42	39	12	7	*
September, 1992	43	37	13	6	1

PEW.1 CONTINUED…

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
May, 1992	39	39	15	6	1
March, 1992	47	38	11	4	*
February, 1992	47	37	10	6	*
January, 1992	44	40	11	5	*
October, 1991	36	38	16	9	1
c. The NFL owners and players reaching a labor agreement					
July 28-31, 2011	12	16	23	48	1
July 21-22, 2011: *A tentative deal in the NFL labor dispute that threatened to delay the football season*	11	13	20	55	1
d. Recent ups and downs in the stock market					
July 28-31, 2011	18	23	20	39	1
TREND FOR COMPARISON:					
January 27-30, 2011: *Recent gains in the stock market*	13	17	20	49	1
August 12-15, 2010: *Recent ups and downs in the stock market*	17	21	20	42	1
March 26-29, 2010	13	23	23	40	1
October 16-19, 2009: *Recent gains in the stock market*	15	23	19	43	*
July 24-27, 2009	23	25	24	28	*
March 13-16, 2009	38	31	14	17	0
March 6-9, 2009: *Recent major drops in the U.S. stock market*	35	31	15	19	*
February 20-23, 2009	31	32	20	17	*
November 21-24, 2008	50	23	15	12	*
October 17-20, 2008: *Recent major ups and downs in the U.S. stock market*	54	31	9	6	*
October 10-13, 2008: *Recent major drops in the U.S. stock market*	59	26	9	6	*
July 3-7, 2008: *Recent major ups and downs in the U.S. stock market*	22	29	23	26	*
March 14-17, 2008	25	31	23	21	*
January 25-28, 2008	29	28	19	23	1
August 17-20, 2007	21	24	22	33	*
July 27-30, 2007	15	26	21	37	1
March 2-5, 2007: *The recent drop in the U.S. stock market*	21	28	25	26	*
Early September, 2002: *Recent major ups and downs in the U.S. stock market*	27	30	20	22	1
Late July, 2002	33	33	15	18	1
March, 2001	27	27	18	27	1
Mid-October, 2000	20	26	23	31	1
April, 2000	18	28	23	31	*
Early April, 2000	19	29	20	32	*
Early April, 2000	19	29	20	32	*
March, 2000	23	29	21	26	1
March, 1999	18	29	22	31	*
January, 1999	24	28	19	28	1
Early September, 1998	32	31	20	17	*
Mid-August, 1998	17	23	21	39	*
January, 1998	21	25	23	31	*
Mid-November, 1997	25	36	18	20	1

PEW.1 CONTINUED…

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
Early November, 1997: *Thinking about last Monday when the stock market dropped, how closely did you follow what was happening?*	16	29	22	33	*
September, 1997: *Recent major ups and downs in the stock market*	14	22	23	40	1
April, 1997	17	21	22	40	*
February, 1996	12	20	25	42	1
e. News about candidates for the 2012 presidential elections					
July 28-31, 2011	17	27	21	35	1
July 21-24, 2011	17	22	28	32	*
July 14-17, 2011	18	26	27	28	1
July 7-10, 2011	16	23	27	33	1
June 30-July 3, 2011	21	28	24	25	2
June 23-26, 2011	19	26	24	31	*
June 16-19, 2011	23	29	23	25	*
June 9-12, 2011	18	30	22	30	1
June 2-5, 2011	21	31	22	26	*
May 26-29, 2011	20	27	24	28	*
May 19-22, 2011	15	27	24	32	1
May 12-15, 2011	15	22	26	35	1
May 5-8, 2011	16	24	27	32	1
April 21-25, 2011	18	26	23	32	1
April 14-17, 2011	20	23	29	27	1
March 24-27, 2011	13	19	26	41	1
March 10-13, 2011	15	21	26	38	0
February 10-13, 2011	16	19	24	40	*
February 3-6, 2011	15	20	23	42	*
TRENDS FOR COMPARISON:					
2008 Election					
October 31-November 3, 2008: *News about the presidential election*	57	29	9	5	*
October 24-27, 2008: *News about candidates for the 2008 presidential election*	44	36	11	8	1
October 17-20, 2008	61	28	7	4	*
October 10-13, 2008	52	31	12	5	*
October 3-6, 2008	57	31	8	4	*
September 26-29, 2008	56	29	10	5	*
September 19-22, 2008	47	33	14	6	*
September 12-15, 2008	40	38	14	7	1
September 5-8, 2008	45	39	12	4	*
August 29-31, 2008	45	32	15	8	*
August 22-25, 2008	31	36	22	11	*
August 15-18, 2008	25	41	19	14	1
August 8-11, 2008	27	38	22	13	*
August 1-4, 2008	30	42	19	9	*
July 25-28, 2008	30	34	21	15	*
July 18-21, 2008	30	35	21	14	*
July 11-14, 2008	28	34	22	15	1
July 3-7, 2008	25	35	23	17	*
June 27-30, 2008	39	33	18	10	*
June 20-23, 2008	28	38	22	12	*
June 13-16, 2008	35	35	20	10	*
June 6-9, 2008	38	35	17	10	*
May 30-June 2, 2008	30	35	21	14	*
May 22-25, 2008	32	37	20	11	*

PEW.1 CONTINUED…

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
May 16-19, 2008	33	37	19	10	1
May 9-12, 2008	35	36	18	11	*
May 2-5, 2008	27	35	23	14	1
April 25-28, 2008	34	37	18	11	*
April 18-21, 2008	29	41	19	10	1
April 11-14, 2008	31	37	22	10	*
April 4-7, 2008	33	36	17	14	*
March 28-31, 2008	31	41	18	10	*
March 20-24, 2008	34	37	18	11	*
March 14-17, 2008	40	37	16	7	*
March 7-10, 2008	39	36	15	9	1
February 29-March 3, 2008	43	34	14	9	*
February 22-25, 2008	42	37	13	8	*
February 15-18, 2008	44	36	10	10	*
February 8-11, 2008	39	37	15	9	0
February 1-4, 2008	37	35	16	12	*
January 25-28, 2008	36	37	14	12	1
January 18-21, 2008	36	34	18	12	*
January 11-14, 2008: *News about the New Hampshire primaries and the presidential campaign*	32	31	19	17	1
January 4-7, 2008: *News about candidates for the 2008 presidential election*	33	36	19	11	1
December 14-17, 2007	25	34	22	19	*
December 7-10, 2007	24	35	22	19	*
November 30 – December 3, 2007	23	35	23	19	*
November 23-26, 2007	20	33	26	20	1
November 16-19, 2007	26	33	21	19	1
November 9-12, 2007	21	33	25	21	*
November 2-5, 2007	27	30	21	21	1
October 26-29, 2007	21	34	26	19	*
October 19-22, 2007	23	32	22	23	*
October 12-15, 2007	13	31	26	30	*
October 5-8, 2007	22	30	24	24	*
September 28 – October 1, 2007	21	34	25	20	*
September 21-24, 2007	24	31	22	23	*
September 14-17, 2007	22	31	24	23	*
September 7-10, 2007	18	34	26	22	*
August 30-September 2, 2007	19	35	21	25	*
August 24-27, 2007	22	28	24	26	*
August 17-20, 2007	19	27	24	30	*
August 10-13, 2007	23	32	21	24	*
August 3-6, 2007	19	31	25	25	*
July 27-30, 2007	19	32	22	26	1
July 20-23, 2007	16	26	30	27	1
July 13-16, 2007	17	29	27	27	*
July 6-9, 2007	24	29	24	22	1
June 29-July 2, 2007	20	32	25	23	*
June 22-25, 2007	18	31	21	30	*
June 15-18, 2007	17	32	26	25	*
June 8-11, 2007	19	30	24	26	1
June 1-4, 2007	16	27	32	24	1
May 24-27, 2007	22	33	23	22	*
May 18-21, 2007	18	31	24	27	*
May 11-14, 2007	18	30	23	28	1
May 4-7, 2007	23	34	21	21	1
April 27-30, 2007	14	30	29	26	1
April 20-23, 2007	18	28	27	27	*
April 12-16, 2007	18	28	27	27	*

PEW.1 CONTINUED...

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
April 5-9, 2007	25	30	26	19	*
March 30-April 2, 2007	20	29	27	23	1
March 23-26, 2007	20	32	22	26	*
March 16-19, 2007	15	28	29	27	1
March 9-12, 2007	24	30	23	23	*
March 2-5, 2007	19	31	26	23	1
February 23-26, 2007	22	33	24	21	*
February 16-19, 2007	18	32	22	27	1
February 9-12, 2007	24	30	24	21	1
February 2-5, 2007	24	36	22	18	*
January 26-29, 2007	24	33	23	20	*
January 19-22, 2007: *Recent announcements by prominent Democrats about plans to run for president in 2008*	24	27	22	26	1
2004 Election					
November, 2004: *News about the presidential election*	47	35	10	7	1
Mid-October, 2004: *News about candidates for the 2004 presidential election*	46	30	12	11	1
September, 2004	40	34	14	11	1
August, 2004	32	38	16	14	*
July, 2004	29	37	18	15	1
June, 2004	28	34	19	18	1
April, 2004	31	33	19	16	1
Mid-March, 2004	35	34	18	13	*
Late February, 2004 **(GAP)**	24	40	23	12	1
Early February, 2004: *The race for the Democratic presidential nomination*	29	37	20	13	1
Mid-January, 2004	16	30	27	26	1
Early January, 2004	14	32	30	23	1
December, 2003	16	26	27	30	1
November, 2003	11	26	34	28	1
October, 2003	12	27	28	32	1
September, 2003	17	25	30	27	1
Mid-August, 2003	12	27	27	33	1
May, 2003	8	19	31	41	1
January, 2003: *Recent announcements by prominent Democrats about plans to run for president in 2004*	14	28	29	28	1
2000 Election					
Early November, 2000: *News about the presidential election*	33	41	15	10	1
Mid-October, 2000: *News about the presidential election campaign*	36	35	17	11	1
Early October, 2000	35	35	19	10	1
September, 2000	22	42	21	15	1
July, 2000: *News about candidates for the 2000 presidential election*	21	38	20	20	1
June, 2000	23	32	23	21	1
May, 2000	18	33	26	23	*
April, 2000	18	39	22	20	1
Early April, 2000					
March, 2000	26	41	19	13	1
February, 2000	26	36	21	17	*
January, 2000	19	34	28	18	1
December, 1999	16	36	24	23	1
October, 1999	17	32	28	22	1
September, 1999	15	31	33	20	1
July, 1999	15	38	24	22	1

PEW.1 CONTINUED...

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
June, 1999	11	25	29	34	1
1996 Election					
November, 1996: *News about the presidential election*	28	42	19	10	*
October, 1996: *News about the presidential election campaign*	31	39	18	12	*
Early September, 1996	24	36	23	17	*
July, 1996	22	40	23	14	1
April, 1996	23	35	25	17	*
March, 1996 *News about the Republican presidential candidates*	26	41	20	13	*
January, 1996	10	34	31	24	1
October, 1995	12	36	30	22	*
August, 1995	13	34	28	25	*
June, 1995	11	31	31	26	1
1992 Election					
October, 1992: *News about the presidential election (RVs)*	55	36	8	2	0
September, 1992: *News about the presidential election campaign*	42	37	13	8	*
August, 1992: *News about the presidential election* (RVs)	36	51	11	2	0
July, 1992: *News about the presidential campaign*	20	45	26	9	*
May, 1992: *The presidential election campaign*	32	44	16	8	*
March, 1992: *The race for the Democratic presidential nomination*	35	40	16	9	*
March, 1992: *The race for the Republican presidential nomination*	25	40	22	13	1
February 1992: *The Democratic primary in New Hampshire*	19	31	26	24	*
February, 1992: *The Republican primary in New Hampshire*	19	31	26	23	1
January, 1992: *News about the Democratic candidates for the presidential nomination*	11	25	36	27	1
December, 1991	10	28	32	30	*
October, 1991	12	26	31	29	2
1988 Election					
October, 1988: *News about the presidential campaign in 1988* (RVs)	43	44	11	2	*
August, 1988 (RVs)	39	45	13	3	*
May, 1988 (RVs)	22	46	23	6	3
November, 1987: *News about the Democratic candidates for the presidential nomination*	15	28	35	21	1
November, 1987: *News about the Republican candidates for the presidential nomination*	13	28	36	22	1
September, 1987: *Coverage of the Democratic* and *Republican candidates for the presidential nomination*	14	34	37	14	1
f. Discussions in Washington about how to address the federal budget deficit and national debt					
July 28-31, 2011	41	27	15	17	*
July 21-24, 2011	38	28	17	17	*
July 14-17, 2011	34	29	18	19	*

PEW.1 CONTINUED…

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
July 7-10, 2011	25	30	21	23	*
June 30-July 3, 2011	29	30	15	25	2
TRENDS FOR COMPARISON:					
June 16-19, 2011: *Debate in Washington over whether to raise the federal debt limit*	24	26	22	28	*
June 2-5, 2011	23	24	22	31	*
May 26-29, 2011: *Discussions in Washington about how to address the federal budget deficit*	25	26	20	29	*
May 12-15, 2011	21	26	24	28	1
May 5-8, 2011: *Discussions in Washington about how to address the federal budget deficit and national debt*	29	28	22	20	1
April 21-25, 2011	30	31	18	21	*
April 14-17, 2011	36	27	18	19	1
April 7-10, 2011: *The threat of a government shutdown because of budget disagreements in Washington*	47	26	15	12	*
March 31-April 3, 2011: *Discussions in Washington about how to address the federal budget deficit*	30	27	21	22	*
March 17-20, 2011	24	25	24	26	1
March 3-6, 2011	26	29	19	26	1
February 17-20, 2011	27	30	17	25	1
December 2-5, 2010	35	25	21	17	2
November 11-14, 2010: *Proposals made by leaders of the federal budget deficit commission*	15	21	21	41	1
January 9-12, 2009: *Projections of a record high federal budget deficit this year*	35	30	19	16	*
November, 1990: *Congressional and administration efforts to reach a budget deficit agreement*	34	33	20	11	2
October, 1990: *Attempts by Congress and the administration to find ways to reduce the budget deficit*	34	37	17	12	*

ASK ALL:

PEW.2 Which ONE of the stories I just mentioned have you followed most closely, or is there another story you've been following MORE closely? [**DO NOT READ LIST. ACCEPT ONLY ONE RESPONSE.]**

Jul 28-31 2011	
40	Discussions in Washington about how to address the federal budget deficit and national debt
12	A bombing and shooting attack in Norway that killed more than 70 people
12	Reports about the condition of the U.S. economy
8	The NFL owners and players reaching a labor agreement
3	News about candidates for the 2012 presidential elections
2	Recent ups and downs in the stock market
7	Some other story **(VOL.)**
16	Don't know/Refused **(VOL.)**

ASK ALL:

PEWWP.1 If you had to use one single word to describe your impression of the budget negotiations in Washington, what would that one word be? **[IF "DON'T KNOW" PROBE ONCE:** It can be anything, just the first word that comes to mind...**] [OPEN END: ENTER VERBATIM RESPONSE]**[1]

Jul 28-31 2011		Apr 9-10 2011
66	Ridiculous	29
42	Disgust/Disgusted/Disgusting	22
36	Stupid/Stupidity	13
26	Frustrated/Frustrating	14
25	Poor/Poorly	7
25	Terrible	7
24	Disappointing/Disappointment/Disappointed	13
23	Childish	6
22	Mess/Messy	14
22	Joke	
17	Pathetic	4
16	Confusing	4
14	Crazy	
13	Bad	
12	Idiot/Idiotic	5
11	Disaster	
11	Suck/Sucks	4
10	Sad	
9	Bull/Bull****	12
9	Chaos/Chaotic	4
9	Disgrace	
8	Lousy	
7	Politics/Political	4
7	Stinks	5
7	Outrageous	
7	Pitiful	
7	Scary	
6	Compromise	
5	Fair	5
5	Horrible	5
5	Difficult	
5	Juvenile	
5	Ludicrious	
5	Selfish	
5	Stalemate	
5	Complicated	
5	Incapable/incompetent	
5	Screwed up	
4	Concerned	
4	Futile	
4	Greed	
4	Sorry	
4	Asinine	
4	Awful	
4	Obama	
4	Stubborn	
4	Unfair	
305	Other	202
119	Don't know/Refused	45

NOTE: The numbers listed represent the number of respondents who offered each response; the numbers are not percentage. Words with fewer than 4 mentions not shown.

In April this question was asked Saturday and Sunday only (N=427).

[1] PEWWP.1 and PEWWP.2a-e asked in conjunction with *The Washington Post*.

ASK ALL:

PEWWP.2 As a result of the budget negotiations in Washington over the last several weeks, have you come to have a MORE favorable opinion of **[INSERT ITEM, USE FULL TITLE AND NAME FOR ITEMS A-B; RANDOMIZE]** a LESS favorable opinion of **[INSERT ITEM, USE FIRST AND LAST NAME ONLY FOR ITEMS A-B]** or hasn't your opinion of [him/them] changed?

	More favorable	Less favorable	Opinion has not changed	(VOL.) DK/Ref
a. President Barack Obama				
July 28-31, 2011	18	37	44	2
b. Speaker of the House John Boehner				
July 28-31, 2011	11	34	45	9
c. Democrats in Congress				
July 28-31, 2011	13	30	53	5
d. Republicans in Congress				
July 28-31, 2011	11	42	44	4
e. Members of Congress affiliated with the Tea Party movement				
July 28-31, 2011	11	37	45	6

TREND FOR COMPARISON:

In the past few weeks, have you come to have a MORE favorable opinion of Barack Obama, a LESS favorable opinion of Barack Obama, or hasn't your opinion of him changed lately?

	More favorable	Less favorable	Opinion has not changed	(VOL.) DK/Ref
January 29-February 1, 2010	18	22	57	3
January 22-25, 2010	8	33	55	4
December 4-7, 2009	12	27	57	3
September 11-14, 2009	19	26	53	1
June 25-28, 2009	13	20	63	4
May 21-24, 2009	18	21	60	1
April 9-13, 2009	20	18	60	2
March 20-23, 2009	22	19	56	3
February 27-March 2, 2009	23	20	56	1
February 6-9, 2009	23	16	60	1
2008 CAMPAIGN TREND FOR COMPARISON:[2]				
October 31-November 3, 2008	25	25	49	1
October 24-27, 2008	24	21	52	3
October 17-20, 2008	33	23	43	1
October 10-13, 2008	29	21	48	2
October 3-6, 2008	28	23	47	2
September 26-29, 2008	31	23	45	1
September 19-22, 2008	25	20	53	2
September 12-15, 2008	20	20	58	2
September 5-8, 2008	20	20	59	1
August 29-31, 2008	29	19	50	2
August 22-25, 2008	22	21	54	3
August 15-18, 2008	16	21	60	3

[2] For March 20-24, 2008, through October 31-November 3, 2008, the introduction read, "In the past few days." For September 12-15 through October 31-November 3, 2008, the question asked respondents to "Please think about each of the following candidates," Barack Obama, John McCain, Joe Biden and Sarah Palin in the 2008 presidential and vice presidential elections. For June 13-16, 2008, through September 5-8, 2008, the question was worded, "Please think about each of the following *presidential* candidates…" and asked about Barack Obama and John McCain. For March 20-24, 2008, through June 6-9, 2008, the list of presidential candidates included Hillary Clinton, Barack Obama and John McCain.

PEWWP.2 CONTINUED…	More favorable	Less favorable	Opinion has not changed	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
August 8-11, 2008	15	18	64	3
August 1-4, 2008	16	22	60	2
July 25-28, 2008	17	21	59	3
July 18-21, 2008	16	22	60	2
July 11-14, 2008	15	17	64	4
July 3-7, 2008	17	17	62	4
June 27-30, 2008	21	19	56	4
June 20-23, 2008	16	16	66	2
June 13-16, 2008	17	15	64	4
June 6-9, 2008	19	17	61	3
May 30-June 2, 2008	17	21	58	4
May 22-25, 2008	18	20	60	2
May 16-19, 2008	19	19	59	3
May 9-12, 2008	20	23	55	2
May 2-5, 2008	11	25	59	5
April 25-28, 2008	16	24	58	2
April 18-21, 2008	18	24	54	4
March 28-31, 2008	18	27	52	3
March 20-24, 2008	22	30	46	2

ASK ALL:

PEW.3 On another subject… Please tell if you have done each of the following in the past 12 months, or not. In the past 12 months, have you **[INSERT ITEMS IN ORDER]**, or haven't you done this?

	Yes	No	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
a. Worked with other people from your neighborhood to fix a problem or improve a condition in your community or elsewhere			
July 28-31, 2011	38	62	*
b. Contacted an elected official			
July 28-31, 2011	26	74	*
October, 2006[3]	18	81	1
Early January, 2004	14	86	*
January, 2000	19	81	*

ASK IF CONTACTED ELECTED OFFICIAL IN PAST 12 MONTHS (PEW.3b=1):
ASK ALL:

PEW.4 In the past month, have you contacted an elected official about the debate in Washington over the federal budget, or haven't you done this?

BASED ON TOTAL:

Jul 28-31 2011	
26	Yes, contacted an elected official in the past 12 months
10	Yes, contacted them about the debate over the federal budget deficit
16	No, have not done this
0	Don't know/Refused **(VOL.)**
74	No, have not contacted an elected official in the past 12 months
*	Don't know/Refused **(VOL.)**

[3] In October, 2006 and before respondents were first asked whether they had ever contacted an elected official and if "Yes" had they done this in the last 12 months.